

❏ Karmaṇy-evādhikāras Te ❏

Bhagavad Gītā · Chapter 2 · Verse 47 — Lord Kṛṣṇa to Arjuna · The essence of Karma-Yoga

VERSE 2.47 — THE MOST FAMOUS ŚLOKA OF THE GĪTĀ

कर्मण्येवाधिकारस्ते मा फलेषु कदाचन ।

मा कर्मफलहेतुर्भूर्मा ते सङ्गोऽस्त्वकर्मणि ॥

కర్మణ్యేవాధికారస్తే మా ఫలేషు కదాచన ।

మా కర్మఫలహేతుర్భూర్మా తే సంగోఽస్త్వకర్మణి ॥

karmaṇy evādhikāras te mā phaleṣu kadācana

mā karma-phala-hetur bhūr mā te saṅgo'stv akarmaṇi

“You have the right to perform your duty alone — but never to its fruits. Let not the fruits of action be your motive, nor let your attachment be to inaction.”

✦ Word-by-Word Breakdown

SANSKRIT (IAST)	संस्कृत (Devanāgarī)	తెలుగు (Telugu)	PRONUNCIATION	MEANING
<i>karmaṇi</i>	कर्मणि	కర్మణి	KAR-ma-ni	in (your prescribed) action / duty
<i>eva</i>	एव	ఏవ	E-va	only, certainly (emphatic particle)
<i>adhikārah</i>	अधिकारः	అధికారః	a-dhi-KAA-rah	the right, the entitlement, jurisdiction
<i>te</i>	ते	తే	te	yours, of you
<i>mā</i>	मा	మా	maa	never, do not (prohibitive)
<i>phaleṣu</i>	फलेषु	ఫలేషు	pha-LE-shu	in the fruits / results (of action)
<i>kadācana</i>	कदाचन	కదాచన	ka-DAA-cha-na	at any time, ever
<i>mā</i>	मा	మా	maa	never, let it not be
<i>karma-phala</i>	कर्मफल	కర్మఫల	KAR-ma-PHA-la	the fruit / result of action
<i>hetuḥ</i>	हेतुः	హేతుః	HE-tuh	cause, motive, reason
<i>bhūh</i>	भूः	భూః	bhooḥ	be / become (imperative — “do not be”)
<i>mā</i>	मा	మా	maa	nor, neither (let it not be)
<i>te</i>	ते	తే	te	your, of you
<i>saṅgaḥ</i>	सङ्गः	సంగః	SAN-gah	attachment, clinging, fondness
<i>astu</i>	अस्तु	అస్తు	AS-tu	let it be (imperative of √as)
<i>akarmaṇi</i>	अकर्मणि	అకర్మణి	a-KAR-ma-ni	in inaction, in not-doing

1❏ Right to Action

You are entitled to *do* your duty.

2❏ Not to Fruits

Never claim ownership of results.

3❏ No Motive of Reward

Don't act *because* of the fruit.

4❏ Nor Inaction

And don't cling to doing nothing.

❏ **Combined meaning:** “Your authority is over action alone — never over its fruits. Do not let the result be your motive, yet do not become attached to inaction either.” This is the foundational verse of **Niṣkāma Karma-Yoga** — the path of selfless, dedicated action. Kṛṣṇa teaches Arjuna that freedom lies not in renouncing work, but in renouncing the *anxiety* of its outcome. Act fully, surrender the fruit.

संस्कृत (Devanāgarī)

తెలుగు (Telugu)

IAST Sanskrit

Pronunciation

English Meaning

❏ Bhagavad Gītā 2.47 · The Heart of Karma-Yoga